

8.1 DEFINING HERITAGE

8.1.1 Heritage Items

A heritage item has cultural significance meaning aesthetic, historic, scientific and / or social value for future generations. All heritage items have been assessed as having significance under the criteria established by the NSW Heritage Branch of the Department of Planning and Environment. The basic criteria of assessment include historic, aesthetic, scientific and social significance, rarity and association with institutions, groups or individuals of importance to the community.

Council supports the retention of heritage items in their significant form and setting whilst allowing sympathetic development to occur. As significance includes the setting, grounds and often the interior of buildings these aspects must be addressed in development applications.

Where new buildings or new building work is to be carried out in the context of a heritage site it is important that the character, quality and value of the setting, streetscape and listed item be maintained.

8.1.2 Heritage Conservation Areas

A Heritage Conservation Area contains a group of buildings where historical origins and relationships between various elements create a distinctive character of heritage. The heritage significance may include subdivision and street pattern, form and scale, the consistency of building materials or the common age of the building stock.

Heritage Conservation Areas often contain both Contributory Items and Non Contributory Items. Heritage Conservation Areas respond to natural features including topography, vegetation and views. Such features are considered contributory to the cultural significance of the Heritage Conservation Area and are acknowledged as contributory items. Note, definitions are included at the end of this DCP.

Council encourages the alteration and or replacement of Non Contributory Items in a manner enhancing the defined heritage significance of the Conservation Area. The existence of non-contributory items in a Conservation Area is not considered a basis for the introduction of development which is not cohesive with the identified significance of the Conservation Area.

All new development in a heritage conservation area is treated as 'infill development.' Details of Waverley's Heritage Conservation Areas are provided on Council's website.

8.1.3 Landscape Items and Landscape Conservation Areas

A substantial number of items in Waverley are identified as having Landscape Heritage Significance. These include natural and manmade or cultivated elements both of planted and non-biological forms. Landscape Items and Landscape Conservation Areas are to be treated as are other identified heritage items or conservation areas with any development